

production of Ravel's *Daphnis et Chloé*, which premiered in Paris in 1912. The set was painted by Russian artist Léon Bakst, who became famous for his magnificent costumes and bold, richly colored set designs for Diaghilev. Diaghilev also commissioned the music from Ravel for this ballet.

## Progressive influences

But Ravel's progressive music, and politics, were still not acceptable at the Conservatoire and, despite Fauré's support, he was again thrown out. Undeterred, he continued to compose, and became associated with a group of young musicians known as *Les Apaches* (the Hooligans), who were influenced by the composer Claude Debussy. Ravel had befriended Debussy, who was known as an "Impressionist" composer for the clear textures and subtle colors of his music. Similarly, Ravel's sensual orchestration led to his own nomination as an Impressionist. However, Debussy detested the label, and Ravel also rejected it.

“ I did my work **slowly**, drop by drop. I **tore it out** of me by **pieces**. ”

MAURICE RAVEL

Ravel had still to make his name with the concert-going public. He entered the competition for the prestigious Prix de Rome each year, without success, from 1900 until 1905, when it became obvious that the musical establishment were preventing him from winning, even though he was probably the most gifted of the entrants. In the ensuing scandal, it was revealed that Théodore